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01.10 Introduction

The South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services (SCDHHS) Centralized Intake process ensures that all persons with perceived long-term care needs receive every opportunity for access to Community Long Term Care (CLTC) waivers and programs. The process identifies persons who meet intake criteria and serves as an information and referral source for those who do not meet intake criteria.

Individuals may have more than one CLTC program application open at a time if the situation requires and the appropriate criteria are met. It is important for SCDHHS workers to verify any other program applications and overall status in Phoenix prior to initiating and ending case actions.

01.20 Intake Policy and Procedures

01.21 Referral Sources

A referral to SCDHHS may originate from any knowledgeable source such as:

1. Applicant
2. Family member
3. Interested neighbor or friend
4. Physician
5. Hospital staff
6. Nursing home staff
7. Staff of a public or private agency
8. Medicare – Medicaid Plan (PRIME)

Agencies that might make referrals include, but are not limited to, the Department of Social Services, Department of Health and Human Services, Department of Health and Environmental Control, Aging Agencies, Department of Mental Health, Department of Disabilities and Special Needs, and private home health agencies.

01.22 Confidentiality

Information about Medicaid applicants and recipients shall be safeguarded in accordance with the provisions of the Department of Health and Human Services regulations governing confidentiality and HIPAA (Regulations 126-170, et, seq.,). Confidential information includes, but is not limited to:

1. The name and address of the individual served and the service received;
2. Medical data, including diagnosis and history of disease or disability;
3. Agency evaluation of information about a person;
4. The identity of persons or institutions that furnished health services to a person;
5. The social and economic conditions or circumstances of any person served;
6. Federal program information identified as confidential by the appropriate federal authority

01.23 Coverage of Intake Duties

Intake duties are performed by Centralized Intake. Arrangements should be made to ensure that intake is covered at all times from 8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. on business days and that an intake team member can be reached to handle any urgent intake issues.

Centralized Intake will provide administrative assistance in obtaining application information. This includes the following activities:

- Recording reported functional deficit(s)
- Checking the system for existing records to prevent duplication
- Keying, scanning, and documenting all appropriate information
- Checking the Medicaid system for Medicaid Eligibility and creating new eligibility workflows when appropriate
- Processing Medicaid Eligibility approvals/denials for waiver applicants appropriately

Centralized Intake will verify correct information is keyed under the Participant Information section in Phoenix. MMIS will be checked for Medicaid Eligibility category if appropriate.

Once the applicant has been determined to meet the intake criteria and Medicaid Eligibility has been verified, the case will be released to the Area Office.

01.24 Timeliness Standard for Intake of a Referral

Referrals received through Centralized Intake must be processed within 3 business days following receipt of the referral.

01.25 Referrals

Centralized Intake receives referrals by telephone and electronically.

Telephone Referral

The applicant, family member or interested individual can make a referral via a toll-free telephone number **(888-971-1637)** to initiate an application. The phone line hours are as follows:

Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday 8:30 a.m. - 4:30 p.m.

Wednesday and Friday 8:30 a.m. - 12:30 p.m.

Electronic Referral

The applicant, family member, interested individual or professional may make an electronic referral by entering the necessary information at the website:

<https://phoenix.scdhhs.gov/eref/>

Note: If a walk-in referral is received, the SCDHHS Area Office will provide the referral source with the Centralized Intake contact information to make either a telephone or electronic referral and assist as needed.

When the referral is received, Centralized Intake:

- checks for an existing record in Phoenix.

Note: If a case is currently active in Phoenix, determines if the referral is an application for a different program;

- completes related contacts to the referral source, applicant, and/or Authorized Representative, as needed to accurately obtain ADL information.
- follows document scanning policies. Refer to Documentation policy and scan tag description;
- consults with a SCDHHS Central Office Nurse to confirm functional dependencies needed;
- enters application data in Phoenix as appropriate.

If **Centralized Intake** requires additional information to process a referral and is unable to reach the applicant/ Authorized Representative/referral source, a CLTC Notification Form giving a ten (10) business day notice to call Centralized Intake Staff must be mailed. **This notice will not include the Appeals Notice.** If no response is received within ten (10) business days, the program application should be terminated as “Intake Criteria Not Met”. All actions taken will be documented in the narrative.

01.26 Intake Criteria

The following criteria must be met for a referral to be considered appropriate for intake:

1. Applicant who is requesting waiver services from the Community Choices Program must be 18 years old or older (stated age is acceptable) or must turn 18

years old within 3 months of the application. An applicant who is requesting Medicaid-sponsored nursing home placement has no age restriction.

2. Applicant must be a South Carolina resident or must be currently located in South Carolina. Out-of- state applicants must intend to relocate within South Carolina.
3. Applicant must have a mental or physical impairment that results in a functional dependency. Extensive hands-on assistance is required to constitute a functional dependency as described below.

Assistance in two of the following:

- a. Eating/meal preparation
- b. Toileting
- c. Dressing
- d. Bathing

OR

Assistance in one of the following:

- a. Locomotion
- b. Transfer
- c. Bowel or bladder continence

Note: An applicant who is requesting Medicaid sponsored nursing home placement does not require a functional dependency for intake processing.

01.27 Applicants Who Do Not Meet Intake Criteria

When a person does not meet intake criteria, Centralized Intake will notify the applicant of this decision in writing via the CLTC Notification Form including the Appeals Notice.

Centralized Intake will consult with a SCDHHS Central Office Nurse if it appears the applicant does not meet intake criteria and the applicant wants to continue with the application.

The SCDHHS Central Office Nurse will determine if the applicant meets the intake criteria.

If the applicant does not meet intake criteria, the SCDHHS Central Office Nurse will:

- update the Phoenix Application to reflect the applicant’s dependencies
- explain the CLTC Intake Criteria to the applicant/ Authorized Representative
- discuss other available community resources and provide referral information, as appropriate
- discuss application withdrawal with the applicant/ Authorized Representative.
- If the applicant/ Authorized Representative wishes to withdraw the application:

The SCDHHS Central Office Nurse will:

- terminate the program application as “Declined Participation”
- will create and send CLTC Notification Form including information regarding making a future referral if needed. **This notification will not include the Appeals Notice.**
- If the applicant/ Authorized Representative does not wish to withdraw the application and the applicant has been determined financially eligible, the application will be released to the SCDHHS Area Office for assessment completion. If the SCDHHS worker completes a phone assessment and it appears the applicant is medically ineligible, an in-home assessment will be made.

Note: If the applicant has not been determined financially eligible, the application will remain in Centralized Intake pending approval of the Medicaid Eligibility Workflow in Phoenix.

The SCDHHS Area Office worker will:

- schedule an assessment.
- follow normal Policy and Procedure for Assessment and Level of Care determination.

All discussions with the applicant/ Authorized Representative must be documented in the narrative.

01.28 Financial Eligibility Review

Centralized Intake is responsible for reviewing the Medicaid Eligibility financial

information for applicants applying for a waiver or program during the intake process.

When the referral source is anyone other than Medicaid Eligibility and the applicant has **NO Medicaid Eligibility Pay Category**, Centralized Intake will mail the Medicaid Eligibility Application for Nursing Home, Residential, or In-Home Care- Form 3401. If the applicant is financially eligible under pay category 32, Centralized Intake will mail the Medicaid Eligibility Application for Additional Information for Nursing Home and In-Home Care-Form 3400B.

If an application is released to the SCDHHS Area Office which is later determined to need a Medicaid Eligibility Workflow, a problem should be reported in Phoenix.

Note: Cases released to the SCDHHS Area Office with an active Medicaid Payment Category of 80 (SSI), 10, 15, 16, 19, 33, 54 or 86 which indicates an eligibility end date within ten (10) business days must be monitored closely to ensure the applicant is financially eligible on the date of enrollment. If enrollment is not possible prior to the eligibility end date, financial eligibility must be verified by Medicaid Eligibility prior to enrollment. A Phoenix problem will be submitted requesting a Medicaid Eligibility Workflow be added to the applicant's Phoenix record. Enrollment will remain pending until the Eligibility Workflow is approved or denied by Medicaid Eligibility.

01.29 Application Release to the SCDHHS Area Office

Once an applicant has been determined to meet intake criteria and has been determined financially eligible for the program, **Centralized Intake** will release the application to the SCDHHS Area Office for assignment. An **SCDHHS worker** will document who the case was assigned to in the Area Office.

01.30 Duplicates/Rejection

Centralized Intake will reject additional referrals made on an applicant if there is an active application for the applicant, for the same waiver/program, when the referral is processed. Referrals will also be rejected when Centralized Intake is notified by the referral source that a referral was submitted in error (for example, the referrer states the referral was made for the wrong person or the wrong program).

Multiple Nursing Home referrals/applications are acceptable in certain situations such as one being for conversion and another coming in for placement or multiple conversion applications with different conversion (Level of Care) dates.

Centralized Intake will accept multiples in those situations if they are able to tell the referrals are not duplicates by the conversion dates listed.

If there is an active Nursing Home application and another Nursing Home referral is submitted by Medicaid Eligibility, the latter referral will be rejected. Medicaid Eligibility will sometimes submit another referral because they are not aware that a hospital, nursing facility, etc. has already submitted one.

01.31 Case Transfer Policy

All Waiver applications are auto assigned by Phoenix. All Nursing Home Placement applications will be transferred by Centralized Intake to the SCDHHS Area Office where the applicant resides (per the current address listed on the referral). If it is a PACE Only application, then the application goes to the PACE program area.

If it is a standard desk review assessment for Nursing Home Placement, the SCDHHS Area Office (per residential address) will process the application. If the applicant will need to be seen face to face, the application may be transferred to the SCDHHS Area Office where the applicant is currently located for that SCDHHS Area Office to process the application.

If an applicant has applications for multiple programs, all applications will go the SCDHHS Area Office where the applicant resides and that SCDHHS Area Office can transfer the application to other areas if needed.

Centralized Intake will only transfer cases during intake. Once the case is in the Area Office, the Area Office has the ability to transfer to other area offices as needed, with proper notification to the other Area Office that the case is being transferred.